Area

Exam code: 0607

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Area

What is area?

- **Area** is the **amount of space** within the perimeter of a 2D shape
  - For example, the size of a sports field
- Area is calculated using lengths in **two dimensions**
  - **Units of measure** include mm^2, cm^2, m^2 etc

How do I find the area of a shape on a square grid?

- Count the **total number** of **whole squares** inside the shape
  - You can **shade** or **mark** the squares you have counted so far
- Parts of the shape **may not contain whole squares**
  - Pair up **half squares**, or **parts** of squares, to form whole ones
- There will be a **scale** telling you how much area **one square** represents
  - **Multiply** the number of squares you have counted by this value to find the **total area** of the shape

Help me understand

Examiner Tips and Tricks

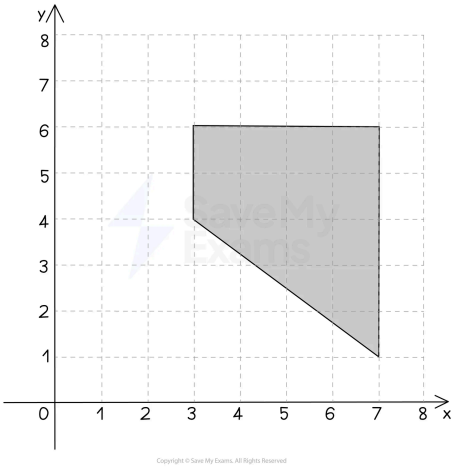
- When counting squares, write down your running total so far in each box.
  - This saves time and ensures you do not count any squares twice.

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

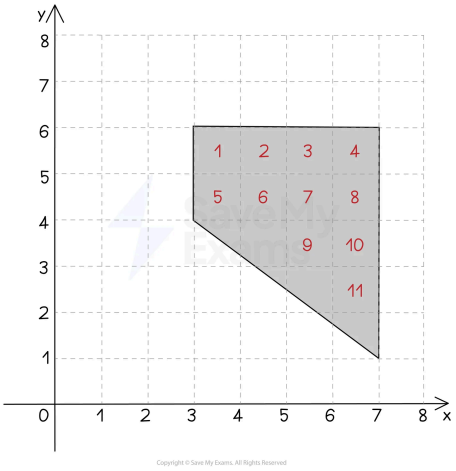
Got it

Worked Example

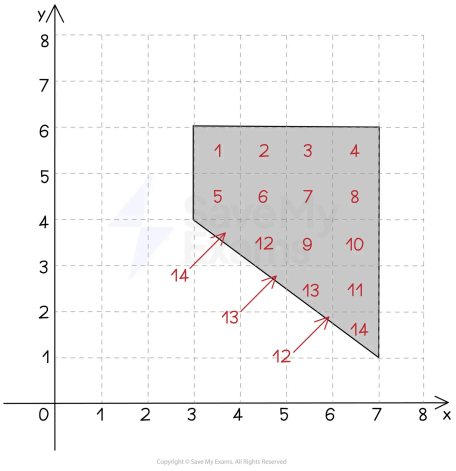


Answer:

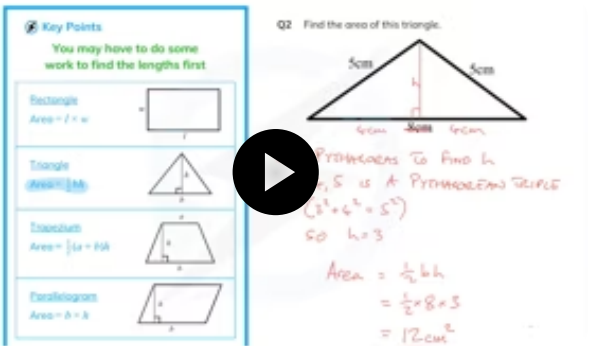
Count the number of whole squares, keeping track of which you have counted so far



Count the partially shaded squares
Try to pair-up fractions of the squares to make whole squares



Total area is 14 cm²



Did this video help you? Yes No

Area Formulas

Which area formulas do I need to know?

Formula you need to learn

How do I find the area of a rectangle?

- The area, A, of a **rectangle** of length, l, and width, w, using the formula
  - $A = l \times w$
    - Multiply together the length and the width

How do I find the area of a triangle?

- $A = \frac{1}{2}bh$
    - **Multiply** the length of the **base** (b) by the **perpendicular height** (h)
    - **Halve** the answer

- The formula for the area of a triangle is given to you in the exam
- The **perpendicular height** may not be the length of one of the sides of the triangle

How do I find the area of a trapezium?

- The area, A, of a **trapezium** with parallel lengths, a and b, and perpendicular height, h, can be found using the formula
    - $A = \frac{1}{2}(a+b)h$
        - **Add** together the lengths of the **parallel sides**
        - **Multiply** the result by the distance between the parallel sides
        - **Halve** the answer

- You **may** be able to work out the area of a trapezium by **splitting the shape** into a rectangle and triangles if you can't remember the formula

How do I find the area of a parallelogram?

- You can find the area, A, of a **parallelogram** of length, l, and perpendicular height, h, by using the formula
    - $A = bh$
        - **Multiply** the length of the **base** by the **perpendicular height**

- The **perpendicular height** is **not a length** of the parallelogram
- It is the **distance between** the **base** and its **opposite side**
- You can work the area of a parallelogram out by **splitting the shape** into a rectangle and triangles if you can't remember the formula

Examiner Tips and Tricks

- You may have to do some work to find **missing lengths** first.
    - For example, you may need to use **Pythagoras' Theorem** to find a missing length on a triangle.
- The **area of a triangle** is given to you in the exam but you will need to remember the other formulae.

Worked Example

Answer:

Find the area of the trapezium using $A = \frac{1}{2}(a+b)h$

Remember that a and b are the two parallel sides and h is the perpendicular height

$$A = \frac{1}{2}(30+15) \times 20$$

450 cm^2

(b)

Answer:

Find the area of the parallelogram using $A = b \times h$
Remember that b is the base and h is the perpendicular height

$$A = 15 \times 12$$

180 cm^2

(c)

Answer:

Find the area of the right-angled triangle using $A = \frac{1}{2}bh$

Remember that b is the base and h is the perpendicular height

$$A = \frac{1}{2} \times 8 \times 7$$

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